

BIRDS OF PREY

Eagles, hawks, and falcons are birds of prey, or raptors. These strong, fast, fearless birds kill and eat other birds and animals—their prey. Whether they are the size of a sparrow or have a wingspan of 10 feet (three meters), like the condor, they all have three things in common: hooked beaks, sharp claws, and “eagle” eyes that can spot three rabbits more than three miles (five kilometers) away!

Steep stoop

Peregrines have been timed diving at speeds of more than 185 miles (300 kilometers) per hour. At the last moment, they thrust out their feet and stab their victim with their claws.



The biggest nest in the world

Golden eagles' nests, often called aeries, can be over 13 feet (four meters) wide—bigger than some cars! They do not build a new nest every year but fly back to an old nest and just add new twigs. Some nests are hundreds of years old.



Dressed for dinner

Vultures poke their heads into dead animals to eat. Their heads are bare—feathers would get messy!

Wings are swept back, and the tail closes like a fan.

The wings are strong enough to lift the falcon into the air even if it is carrying a dead duck.

Its pointed wings help the peregrine falcon fly faster than any other bird.

The pigeon dies and falls to the ground

The tail is used for steering.

Peregrine falcons are about 13 inches (32 centimeters) tall and live all over the world.